THE SECRETARY OF THE INTERIOR
WASHINGTON

ORDER NO. 3440

Subject: Realignment of Supervision of the Chief, United States Park Police under the Secretary of the Interior, or His Designee

Sec. 1. **Purpose.** This Order realigns the management structure of the United States Park Police (USPP) by providing that the Chief of the USPP will report to and be directly supervised by the Secretary, or his designee. It recognizes that the USPP jurisdiction and responsibility, particularly in the National Capital Region, extends beyond National Park System assets and implicates equities of other Federal agencies and virtually all local jurisdictions, which makes it essential for the USPP to be managed at the highest levels of Department of the Interior (Department).

Sec. 2. **Background.** President George Washington established an organization of "park watchmen" in 1791 to patrol public buildings and spaces in the Nation's capital. This organization became part of the Department in 1849 and was given its current name in 1919. Over time, the USPP obtained substantial law enforcement jurisdiction in Washington, DC, and its environs, as well as authority to operate in New York City and San Francisco pursuant to designation as peace and/or police officers. Thus, the USPP operates pursuant to law enforcement authority that extends beyond the geographic boundaries of park land. This authority is distinct from the general National Park Service (NPS) law enforcement authority that is carried out by park rangers, although the USPP can exercise that authority as well.

Sec. 3. **Authority.** This Order is issued under the authority of section 2 of Reorganization Plan No. 3 of 1950 (64 Stat.1262) and other authorities applicable to the USPP.

Sec. 4. **Realignment of Supervision of the Chief of the U.S. Park Police.**

a. Effective on the date of this Order, supervision of the USPP is realigned under the Secretary, or his designee. The Chief of the USPP shall thereafter be in a direct reporting relationship to the Secretary, or his designee, who will provide strategic management and operational control of the USPP. The authority of any other official subordinate to the Secretary, or his designee, to supervise, manage, oversee, evaluate, or otherwise direct the activities of the Chief of the USPP is hereby suspended.

b. The Assistant Secretary for Fish and Wildlife and Parks (AS-FWP), NPS Director, and other officials will continue to provide administrative, budget, human resources, property management, and similar support to the USPP. The AS-FWP and NPS Director are responsible to ensure that such support continues

without interruption, and in a manner that does not interfere with the Secretary's supervision and management control over the USPP.

Sec. 5. **Implementation.** The Assistant Secretary – Policy, Management and Budget, AS-FWP, and NPS Director are responsible for incorporating the changes established in this Order into appropriate sections of the Departmental Manual and NPS policies, as well as taking any other necessary steps to ensure compliance with external requirements relating to the changes.

Sec. 6. **Effective Date.** This Order is effective immediately and will remain in effect until the changes are incorporated into the Departmental Manual and NPS policies, or until it is amended, superseded, or revoked, whichever occurs first.

Aug 25, 2025
Date:

Secretary of the Interior